

Supplementary Material

Wide-Scale Sampling with Hard-Argmin Selection and CBF Projection for Safe Quadrotor Navigation in Narrow Passages

1 Cross-Task Generalisation and Cross-Configuration Robustness

1.1 Cross-Task Generalisation

Table 1 reports cross-task results on TWO_GATE and U_SHAPE ($K = 10$, $N_{MC} = 40$).

Table 1: Cross-task generalisation ($K = 10$, $N_{MC} = 40$).

Task	Method	Succ.	TErr [m]	IAE
TWO_GATE	PD	40/40	0.045	5.84
TWO_GATE	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	40/40	0.031	5.56
U_SHAPE	PD	40/40	0.054	6.82
U_SHAPE	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	40/40	0.040	6.54

Bootstrap 95% CIs on ΔTErr and ΔIAE exclude zero for both tasks ($\Delta\text{TErr} \approx -0.015$ $[-0.022, -0.008]$, $\Delta\text{IAE} \approx -0.29$ $[-0.37, -0.21]$).

1.2 Cross-Configuration Robustness

Table 2 provides full cross-configuration results with bootstrap CIs. Controllers use $K = 10$, $N_{MC} = 40$, and are not re-tuned. The PD nominal uses $m = 1.5$ kg throughout.

Table 2: Cross-configuration robustness on NARROW ($K = 10$, $N_{MC} = 40$). $\Delta = R_{1,\sigma=5} - \text{PD}$ on paired both-success trials.

Config.	PD succ.	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$ succ.	McN. (b, c)	ΔTErr [95% CI]	ΔIAE [95% CI]
nominal (1.5, 0.1)	27/40	40/40	(13, 0)	-0.094 $[-0.125, -0.065]$	-2.02 $[-2.23, -1.81]$
+50% mass (2.25, 0.1)	0/40	31/40	(31, 0)	—	—
+50% drag (1.5, 0.15)	26/40	38/40	(12, 0)	-0.093 $[-0.124, -0.062]$	-1.91 $[-2.19, -1.63]$

McNemar $p < 0.001$ (bold). “—” = $n_{\text{both}} = 0$. Under +50% mass, every PD failure was an $R_{1,\sigma=5}$ success ($b = 31$, $c = 0$).

1.3 Additional Baselines and Three-Seed Replication

Table 3 reports PI-PD, oracle Adaptive-PD, and single-source-wide variants under +50% mass.

Three-seed replication for +50% mass: pooled $R_{1,\sigma=5}$ 99/120 = 82.5% (Wilson 95% CI [74.9%, 88.2%]), PD 0/120.

Table 3: Additional baselines on NARROW, +50% mass ($K = 10$, $N_{\text{MC}} = 40$).

Method	Succ.	Notes
PD ($\sigma = 2$, nominal mass)	0/40	baseline
PI-PD ($K_i = 2$)	0/40	integral correction insufficient
Adaptive-PD (oracle mass)	28/40	requires oracle knowledge
$R_{1,\sigma=5}$ (two-source)	31/40	matches oracle ($p = 0.45$)
$R_{0,\sigma=5}$ (single-source-wide)	32/40	equivalent to $R_{1,\sigma=5}$ ($p = 0.508$)

1.4 Main Narrow-Passage Result: Full Table with CIs

Table ?? reproduces the complete main result including Wilson CIs, McNemar discordant counts, and bootstrap CIs on ΔTErr and ΔIAE .

Table 4: Main result on NARROW ($N_{\text{MC}} = 80$ paired trials, full). Bold = significant ($p < 0.05$, CI excludes zero).

K	Method	succ. (Wilson 95% CI)	TErr	IAE	McNemar (b, c)	ΔTErr [95% CI]	ΔIAE [95% CI]
5	PD	46/80 = 57.5% [46.4, 67.9]	0.644	9.31	—	—	—
5	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	70/80 = 87.5% [78.5, 93.0]	0.171	6.94	(3, 27), $p < 0.001$	-3.04 [-4.26, -1.92]	-5.11 [-6.51, -3.7]
10	PD	53/80 = 66.3% [55.4, 75.6]	0.380	8.53	—	—	—
10	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	79/80 = 98.8% [93.2, 99.8]	0.039	6.22	(1, 27), $p < 0.001$	-3.29 [-4.40, -2.29]	-5.64 [-6.95, -4.3]
20	PD	59/80 = 73.8% [63.1, 82.2]	0.273	8.03	—	—	—
20	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	77/80 = 96.3% [89.6, 98.7]	0.040	5.82	(1, 19), $p < 0.001$	-2.29 [-3.28, -1.30]	-4.54 [-5.75, -3.3]

1.5 TSH-NMPC Algorithm and Default Hyperparameters

Algorithm 1.4 summarises one closed-loop step of TSH-NMPC. Table 4 lists the default hyperparameters used throughout Section 5 of the main text.

[h] [1] state x_t , setpoint x_{sp} , budget K , scale σ_r , horizon S $u_{\text{pd}} \leftarrow m(K_p(p_{\text{sp}} - p_t) + K_d(v_{\text{sp}} - v_t))$ PD nominal sample $u^{(1:K)} \sim \mathcal{N}(u_{\text{pd}}, \sigma_r^2 I)$ wide-scale PD-centred clip $u^{(1:K)}$ to $[u_{\text{min}}, u_{\text{max}}]$ $k = 1, \dots, K$ (**vectorized**) simulate S -step rollout; compute $J^{(k)}$ via cost $u_{\text{nom}} \leftarrow u^{(\arg \min_k J^{(k)})}$ hard-argmin build $(A(x_t), b(x_t))$ from DT-CCBF $u_{\text{safe}} \leftarrow \text{solve QP}$; fallback if infeasible u_{safe} Two-source variant: replace Line 3 with $K_A \leftarrow \lfloor K/2 \rfloor$ tight samples at $\sigma_{\text{pd}} = 2$ plus $K_B = K - K_A$ wide samples at σ_r .

Table 5: TSH-NMPC hyperparameters (defaults used throughout the experiments).

Symbol	Default	Role
K	10	total candidate budget
σ_r	5.0 N	wide-scale noise (per axis; operating plateau [5, 8])
σ_{pd}	2.0 N	tight-scale noise (legacy; two-source variant only)
S	20 (= 0.4 s)	rollout horizon
κ	5	DT-CCBF LSE smoothness

1.6 σ_r Sweep: Full Table

Table 5 provides the complete σ_r sweep with bootstrap CIs on ΔTErr and ΔIAE vs. PD.

Table 6: σ_r sweep on NARROW ($K = 10$, $N_{\text{MC}} = 40$). PD baseline: 27/40, TErr = 0.294, IAE = 8.52.

σ_r [N]	succ.	TErr [m] (succ.)	IAE (succ.)	McNemar (b, c), p vs PD	ΔTErr , ΔIAE
1	30/40 = 75.0%	0.261	8.00	(5, 2), 0.453 (n.s.)	-0.043 [-0.070, -0.016]
2	36/40 = 90.0%	0.236	7.54	(9, 0), 0.004	-0.065 [-0.092, -0.038]
3	34/40 = 85.0%	0.195	7.28	(9, 2), 0.065 (marg.)	-0.065 [-0.094, -0.036]
5	40/40 = 100%	0.036	6.23	(13, 0), < 0.001	-0.094 [-0.125 , -0.063]
8	40/40 = 100%	0.016	5.33	(13, 0), < 0.001	-0.094 [-0.126 , -0.062]

2 MPPI, CEM, and iCEM Sweep Data

Table 6 compares MPPI, CEM, iCEM, and hard-argmin at $K = 10$, $\sigma \in \{2, 5\}$. Table 7 reports the MPPI temperature sweep.

Table 7: MPPI/CEM/iCEM vs. hard-argmin on NARROW ($N_{\text{MC}} = 40$, seed 7777).

Method	σ	n_{iter}	Succ. (nominal)	Succ. (+50% mass)	TErr (nominal) [m]
MPPI ($\lambda = 0.1$)	2	1	22/40	1/40	~ 0.25
MPPI ($\lambda = 5.0$)	5	1	39/40	—	~ 0.16
CEM	2	3	24/40	2/40	~ 0.20
CEM	5	3	40/40	—	0.110
iCEM	2	3	40/40	—	~ 0.043
$R_{1,\sigma=5}$ (hard-argmin)	5	1	40/40	32/40	0.036

iCEM latency ≈ 58.8 ms vs. ≈ 6 ms for hard-argmin. CEM uses $3\times$ the effective rollout budget at $n_{\text{iter}} = 3$.

Table 8: MPPI λ sweep on NARROW ($K = 10$, $\sigma = 2$, $N_{\text{MC}} = 80$, seed 7777).

λ	Succ.	TErr [m]	IAE
0.01	41/80 = 51.3%	0.455	8.48
0.05	44/80 = 55.0%	0.424	8.36
0.1	46/80 = 57.5%	0.392	8.22
0.5	41/80 = 51.3%	0.442	8.52
1.0	45/80 = 56.3%	0.425	8.41
5.0	44/80 = 55.0%	0.480	8.53

The narrow-scale PD baseline at $K = 10$, $\sigma = 2$ achieves 66.3% (Table 2, main text). At matched $\sigma = 2$, MPPI does not reach the PD baseline.

3 Negative Ablation: Learned Prior vs. Random Wide Source

3.1 $N_{\text{MC}} = 80$ Full Table

Table 8 provides the full $N_{\text{MC}} = 80$ head-to-head (seed 7777). A_3 uses a 27,935-parameter TRM as Source B; the random source uses $\sigma = 5$.

Table 9: Negative ablation on NARROW ($N_{\text{MC}} = 80$, seed 7777).

K	Method	Succ. / 80	TErr [m]	IAE	vs. $R_{1,\sigma=5}$ p
5	PD	34/80 = 42.5%	0.117	8.29	—
5	A_3	63/80 = 78.8%	0.069	6.38	0.572 (n.s.)
5	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	67/80 = 83.8%	0.044	6.65	—
10	PD	54/80 = 67.5%	0.110	7.91	—
10	A_3	73/80 = 91.2%	0.030	5.92	0.180 (n.s.)
10	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	78/80 = 97.5%	0.034	6.23	—
20	PD	70/80 = 87.5%	0.084	7.52	—
20	A_3	75/80 = 93.8%	0.022	5.65	0.219 (n.s.)
20	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	79/80 = 98.8%	0.016	5.75	—

A_3 vs. $R_{1,\sigma=5}$ is underpowered at this sample size ($\Delta_{\min} \approx 0.12$; observed $p \geq 0.180$).

3.2 $N_{\text{MC}} = 300$ Headline

$N_{\text{MC}} = 300$ (seed 7777): $R_{1,\sigma=5}$ 293/300 = 97.7%; $R_{0,\sigma=5}$ 296/300 = 98.7%; A_3 266/300 = 88.7%. McNemar A_3 vs. $R_{1,\sigma=5}$: $p = 7.4 \times 10^{-6}$ (minimum detectable $\Delta_{\min} \approx 0.06$).

3.3 TRM Architecture

The TRM is a weight-shared latent recursive network (64-dim latent, 16 recursive steps, 27,935 parameters) mapping $[x_t, x_{\text{sp}}]$ to a 30-dim control sequence. Only the first 3 dims are used for candidate generation. Training: 50,000 samples from 500 closed-loop PD+CBF trajectories. A second TRM trained on NARROW trajectories (9 $\times$ better single-step TErr) yielded worse closed-loop A_3 , consistent with diversity collapse of a sharper proposal.

4 CasADi+IPOPT NLP NMPC Details

4.1 NLP Formulation

Multiple-shooting with CasADi Opti + IPOPT, using identical Q, R weights and soft obstacle penalty ($\rho = 2000$, $\delta = 0.3$ m) as TSH-NMPC (Eq. 6, main text). Horizons: $H = 10$ (0.2 s) and $H = 20$ (0.4 s). Unlike TSH-NMPC, no separate CBF projection; the soft obstacle penalty is part of the NLP cost. Latency includes full Opti stack overhead and IPOPT solve on the same single-threaded x86 CPU.

4.2 Full Latency Distribution

Table 9 reports per-step latency from a profiling run ($N_{\text{MC}} = 40$, 150 steps each).

4.3 Full Comparison Table

Table 10 reproduces the complete CasADi comparison including $H=10$, P99, and deadline-overflow columns omitted from the compact version in the main text.

Table 10: Per-step latency distribution on NARROW ($N_{MC} = 40, 150$ steps).

Metric	CasADi $H=10$	CasADi $H=20$	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$ $K=10$	PD $K=10$
Mean [ms]	3.20	5.16	10.72	19.61
Median [ms]	2.66	3.74	10.67	17.28
Std [ms]	1.27	2.75	2.13	8.38
CV	0.40	0.53	0.20	0.43
p95 [ms]	5.73	10.17	14.21	34.69
p99 [ms]	6.89	11.91	16.25	54.25
Max [ms]	19.96	35.02	32.35	152.71
% > 20 ms	0.00%	0.12%	0.17%	31.60%

Table 11: TSH-NMPC vs. CasADi+IPOPT NMPC (full). “P99” = per-step 99th-percentile latency [ms]; “%>20” = fraction exceeding 20 ms. McNemar (b, c, p) vs. CasADi- $H20$.

Method	Succ.	TErr	Lat	P99	%>20	McN. vs. $H20$
<i>Nominal NARROW $N_{MC} = 80$:</i>						
CasADi- $H10$	1/80	0.746	3.4	6.9	0.00	—
CasADi- $H20$	80/80	0.003	5.3	11.9	0.12	(ref.)
$R_{1,\sigma=5}$ $K=10$	77/80	0.063	5.7	—	—	(3, 0), $p = 0.25$
$R_{1,\sigma=5}$ $K=20$	80/80	0.032	~ 6	—	—	(0, 0), $p = 1.0$
$R_{0,\sigma=5}$ $K=50$	80/80	0.015	~ 10	—	—	(0, 0), $p = 1.0$
<i>+50% mass $N_{MC} = 40$:</i>						
CasADi- $H20$	37/40	0.054	5.3	11.9	0.12	(ref.)
$R_{0,\sigma=5}$ $K=50$	38/40	0.079	~ 10	—	—	(1, 2), $p = 1.0$
$R_{0,\sigma=5}$ $K=150$	40/40	0.044	~ 20	—	—	(0, 3), $p = 0.25$

Latency: per-trial mean-of-per-step-means from the $N_{MC} = 80$ run; the profiling run (Table 9) yields per-step means of 10.7 ms ($K=10$), ~ 12 ms ($K=20$), ~ 20 ms ($K=50$).

5 Robustness, CBF Fallback, and Multiple Comparisons

5.1 CBF Fallback Audit

Table 11 reports CBF QP infeasibility rates on NARROW ($N_{MC} = 40$). Fallback triggers the box-constrained emergency backup ($\delta_{\text{buffer}} = 0.15$ m).

5.2 Dryden Wind Gust

MIL-F-8785C turbulence spectrum: base RMS [0.5, 0.5, 0.3] m/s, length scales $L = [200, 200, 50]$ m, airspeed 5.0 m/s. Intensity $1 \times -5 \times$. First-order gust filters apply $F_d = -b \cdot v_{\text{gust}}$ ($b = 0.1$). On NARROW ($N_{MC} = 40$, $K = 10$): both wide- σ controllers retain 39–40/40, PD drops to 26–28/40 ($p \leq 9.8 \times 10^{-4}$).

5.3 Dynamic Obstacle

Centre obstacle (index 1) moves at $v_y \leq 1.0$ m/s without predictive knowledge. Wide- σ controllers retain 39–40/40, matching CasADi+IPOPT $H = 20$ ($p = 1.0$) at $N_{MC} = 40$, $K = 10$.

Table 12: CBF fallback invocations on NARROW ($N_{MC} = 40$).

Config.	Method	K	Succ.	Fallback rate
nominal	PD	5	25/40	20.4%
nominal	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	5	38/40	9.4%
nominal	PD	10	29/40	$\leq 17\%$
nominal	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	10	—	$\leq 6\%$
+50% mass	PD	10	0/40	42–49%
+50% mass	$R_{1,\sigma=5}$	10	32/40	5–7%

$\Pr[\text{collision} \mid \text{fallback}] = 0/40$ for every method. CBF-disabled: both methods 0/40 (40/40 collisions).

5.4 Multiple-Comparison Correction

Table 12: Holm–Bonferroni for $m = 13$ primary family (paired McNemar $R_{1,\sigma=5}$ vs. PD on NARROW), family-wise $\alpha = 0.05$.

Table 13: Holm–Bonferroni ($m = 13$ primary family).

Rank	Test	p (raw)	Reject ($m = 13$)?
1	crossconfig +50% mass $K=10$	9.3×10^{-10}	Yes
2	negabl A_3 -vs-PD $K=5$	2.8×10^{-9}	Yes
3	main narrow $K=10$	2.2×10^{-7}	Yes
4	main narrow $K=5$	8.4×10^{-6}	Yes
5	crossconfig +50% drag $K=10$	2.4×10^{-4}	Yes
6	main narrow $K=20$	4.0×10^{-5}	Yes
7	crossconfig nominal $K=10$	1.2×10^{-4}	Yes
8–13	cross-task $\Delta TErr$ ($2\times$), A_3 -vs- R_1 ($3\times$)	≥ 0.04	No

7/13 reject at family-corrected level. Extending to $m = 28$ yields the same qualitative conclusions.